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Ministry of Education

MATHEMATICS SYLLABUS
GRADE 4-6

DEVELOPED BY THE CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT CENTRE
LUSAKA
2024

Republic of Zambia

MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

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VISION

Quality, lifelong education for all which is accessible, inclusive and relevant to individual, national and global needs.

PREFACE

The Upper Primary Mathematics Syllabus, is a comprehensive framework designed to equip young learners with the foundational mathematical competencies necessary for their academic journey and beyond. The syllabus is crafted with a firm commitment to competence-based education, recognizing the importance of not just acquiring knowledge, but rather the development of critical thinking, problem-solving skills, and conceptual understanding.

In today's rapidly evolving world, mathematical proficiency is an indispensable asset, enabling individuals to navigate various challenges and opportunities with confidence and dexterity. Therefore, this syllabus is meticulously structured to foster the holistic growth of learners, empowering them to engage meaningfully with mathematical concepts, apply them in real-world scenarios, and cultivate a lifelong appreciation for the beauty and utility of mathematics.

At the heart of this syllabus lies the principle of competence-based learning, which prioritizes the mastery of essential skills and concepts over mere coverage of content. Emphasis is placed on developing not only computational skills but also on nurturing mathematical reasoning, communication, and problem-solving abilities.

Furthermore, this syllabus is designed to be flexible and adaptable, recognizing the diverse learning needs and back grounds of learners. Teachers are encouraged to employ a variety of instructional strategies, resources, and assessment methods to cater to the individual strengths and challenges of their learners, thereby fostering a supportive and inclusive learning environment.As educators, we play a pivotal role in shaping the mathematical literacy and confidence of future generations. With the implementation of this competence-based upper primary mathematics syllabus, we embark on a collective endeavour to inspire curiosity, ignite passion, and unlock the full potential of every young mathematician.

It is our sincere hope that this resource will serve as a guiding light, illuminating the path towards mathematical excellence and empowerment for all learners.

Together, let us embark on this transformative journey towards a future where every child embraces mathematics with enthusiasm, resilience, and mastery.

Kelvin Mambwe (Dr.)
The Permanent Secretary-Educational Services
MINISRTYOFEDUCATION

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The design and development of the Upper Primary Mathematics Syllabus is the culmination of a series of activities which involved many stakeholders. I, therefore, wish to thank individuals, institutions and organisations that provided the financial and technical input to the successful development of this syllabus. These include; teachers, lecturers from Colleges of Education and Universities as well as representatives from cooperating partners. I also wish to thank officials from other Directorates from the Ministry of Education for their valuable contribution to this process.

Finally, I recognise the commitment and hard work of all the staff at the Curriculum Development Centre in ensuring that this syllabus comes to reality.

Charles Ndakala (Dr.)
Director – Curriculum Development
MINISTRY OF EDUCATION

INTRODUCTION

The upper primary mathematics syllabus is designed to provide a comprehensive overview and understanding of fundamental mathematical concepts. The syllabus has been prepared and produced against the background of the need to set high standards for mathematics education and actualise the country's vision from early childhood to tertiary education. The syllabus comprises topics aimed at providing a coherent learning progression based on their interconnection. This syllabus aligns with the 21st Century skills to help learners gain competences that they can utilise in life beyond school. It provides an enriching and supportive educational environment where learners can develop a lifelong interest for mathematics.

It is expected that this syllabus will inspire and empower learners to achieve their full potential, equipping them with the knowledge and skills necessary to navigate and contribute to the world around them. Hence the syllabus aims to provide a solid foundation for Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) education and smooth transition to Secondary Education.

Rationale

Mathematics is a fundamental subject that develops logical reasoning, problem-solving skills, and numerical proficiency essential for everyday life and future learning. The Grade 4–6 mathematics syllabus is designed to build upon the foundational concepts introduced in earlier grades while preparing learners for more advanced mathematical thinking in higher education.

At this stage, learners transition from basic arithmetic to more complex mathematical operations, including fractions, decimals, geometry, measurements, and introductory algebra. These concepts are essential for developing critical thinking, reasoning, and analytical skills necessary for real-world problem-solving. The syllabus emphasizes a learner-centered approach, where leaners actively engage in hands-on activities, group work, and investigations to discover mathematical relationships and patterns.

Ultimately, this syllabus aims to foster mathematical fluency, conceptual understanding, and logical reasoning, equipping learners with the skills needed for further studies in arithmetic and related disciplines.

Structure of the Syllabus

The syllabus outlines the content in form of topics, sub-topics, specific competences, learning activities and expected standard.

Specific Competence

Specific competence refers to a particular skill, values, or knowledge that enables learners to perform a specific mathematical task, solve a particular type of problem, or demonstrate understanding of a distinct mathematical concept. This may be achieved after performing several learning activities for a specific instruction.

Learning activities

A learning activity in mathematics is a task or experience designed to engage learners in the process of learning mathematical concepts, skills, or problem-solving strategies. It is a purposeful and structured experience that aims to promote mathematical understanding, reasoning, and communication. These learning activities ought to help a learner to develop included specific competence based on his or her physical and mental redness.

Expected standard

This is an evaluation criterion upon which the teacher bases his/her judgement of the learners' attainment of a given specific competence.

Mathematics Competence

Mathematics competence is the ability to develop and apply mathematical thinking in order to solve a range of problems in everyday situations. Mathematical competences involve the ability and willingness to use mathematical modes of thought (logical and spatial thinking) and presentation (formulas, models, constructions, graphs, charts). The mathematics competence is developed step-by step over a period of instruction after learning a set of specific competencies.

Suggested Teaching Methodology

The effective teaching methodologies in this mathematics syllabus include:

- **Conducting Research:** demonstrate key principles and encourage curiosity among learners.
- **Collaborative learning**: Pair learners to work together, promoting peer-to-peer teaching, discussion, and problem-solving.
- **Conceptual learning:** Connect mathematical concepts to everyday life, industry, or current events, making learning relevant and meaningful.
- **Differentiated instructions:** Tailor teaching to meet diverse learning styles, abilities, and interests of different learners.
- **Feedback and Reflection:** Encourage learners to reflect on their learning, providing constructive feedback to guide improvement.
- **Inquiry-based learning**: Encourage learners to explore, investigate, and discover mathematical concepts through hands-on experiments and activities.

- **Integration of Technology:** Use digital tools, simulations, and visualisations to enhance engagement, understanding, and analysis.
- **Problem-based learning**: Present real-world problems requiring learners to apply Mathematical knowledge to solve problems.
- **Project -based learning:** Assign open-ended projects, allowing learners to design, conduct, and present research or applications of Mathematical
- concepts.

By implementing these methodologies, a teacher can create an engaging, inclusive, and effective mathematics learning environment.

Time Allocation

The time allocated for mathematics at upper primary school level is 4 hours per week, translating into six (6) periods. The duration for a single period is 40 minutes.

Assessment

Assessment of the learning process is critical in teaching and learning. This helps teachers, parents and school administrators to establish competences where the learners are doing well and where they are struggling. This information should then help the teacher to determine appropriate teaching strategies to respond to learners needs. Learners should be assessed through exercises, observations, interviews, checklists, tests, projects, and examinations.

School based assessment (SBA) will also be conducted. The Examinations Council of Zambia (ECZ) will provide detailed guidelines on how SBA will be conducted.

KEY COMPETENCES TO BE DEVELOPED

S/N	COMPENTENCE	DESCRIPTORS
1	AnalyticalThinking	• Make conclusions based on a thorough analysis of available information • Break down a problem • Compile data, create mental images and address the issues • Evaluate solutions
2	Communication	• Use appropriate mathematical language (verbal and non -verbal) in different situations • Express oneself using different media and symbols • Ask forfeedback
3	Creativity and Innovation	• Apply knowledge and skills in new and creativeways • Express one's idea in a logicalmanner • Set goals for oneself • Use different strategies or approaches in response to a problem or question
4	Collaboration	• Work with others in finding solutions to daily challenges • Respect the views of group members while working together. • Participate fully in the group towards accomplishing a given task
5	CriticalThinking	• Solve problems • Break down texts, to improve the ability to understand

S/N	COMPENTENCE	DESCRIPTORS
		• Analyse ideas and adjust them accordingly • Establish opinions about what is right and wrong • Solve problems with innovative solutions • Deal with life challenges effectively • Evaluate the credibility of sources of information • Collect specific information and present findings of the same. • Analyse information from various sources.
6	Digital Literacy	• Produce graphs for data analysis • Perform successful on line research.
7	Entrepreneurship	• Understand basic concepts of sources of income, saving and budgeting
8	FinancialLiteracy	• Understand foreign currencies • Calculate exchange rates • Set financial goals • Make a saving plan • Prepare a simple budget • Calculate interest
9	Problem Solving	• Weigh up evidence and make appropriate decisions best on experiences and relevant learning. • Use analogies to identify similarities among objects to establish relationships among the known and unknown

GRADE 4

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
4.1. SETS	**4.1.1 Operations on Sets**	4.1.1.1 Apply set operations in everyday life	• Illustrating the concept of intersection set of two given sets and its notation "∩" using life contexts, real objects, computer animations and circle diagrams… • Identifying the intersection set of two sets • Presenting two sets with no common members (*disjoint sets*) • Illustrating the concept of Union set of two given sets and its notation "**U**" using life contexts, real objects, computer animations, circle diagrams… • Identifying the Union set of two sets	• Set operations applied in everyday life appropriately
4.2. NUMBERS	**4.2.1 Numbers and Notation**	4.2.1.1 Use whole numbers to present ideas in life context	• Reading and writing of numbers up to 1 000 000 • Expressing numbers in expanded notation	• Whole numbers used to present ideas in life correctly
	4.2.2 Factors and multiples	4.2.2.1. Apply Factors and Multiples in everyday life	• Illustrating factors of given numbers using hands on activities such as the multiplication table, ladder, and number bonds (*including the use of ICT tools*) • Identifying the Highest Common Factor (HCF) of given numbers. • Illustrating multiples of a given number • Identifying the Lowest Common Multiple (LCM) of given numbers. • Completing number patterns involving multiples	• Factors and multiples applied in everyday life appropriately

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
4.3. FRACTIONS	4.3.1 Common Fractions	4.3.1.1Apply the concept of fractions in different contexts	• Illustrating equivalent fractions • Arranging common fractions either in ascending or descending order, such as using a proportion line • Identifying and representing improper and mixed numbers • Converting mixed numbers to improper fractions and vice versa • Adding and subtracting proper and improper fractions and mixed numbers with a common denominator	• Concept of fractions applied appropriately
	4.3.2. Decimal Fractions	**4.3.2.1**Utilise decimal Fractions in life situations	• Illustrating the understanding of decimal fractions Practically such as relating decimals to common fractions with denominators of 10 and 100 • Identifying place values in a decimal number up to 2 decimal places • Reading and writing decimals (*up to 2 decimal places)* • Adding and subtracting decimal numbers up to 2 decimal places • Multiplying decimal numbers (*up to 2 decimal places)* by whole numbers • Dividing decimal numbers (*up to 2 decimal places*) by whole numbers (*up to 2-digits*) WITHOUT REMAINDER	• Decimal fractions utilised correctly

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
4.4. FINANCIAL ARITHMETIC	**4.4.1 Money**	**4.4.1.1** Apply financial Literacy in daily context	• Making a budget • Illustrating the concept of selling price and cost price	• Financial literacy applied accordingly
4.5. ANGLES	**4.5.1 Types of Angles**	**4.5.1.1** Relate angles to different contexts	• Illustrating the concept of an angle through practical activities *(opening door, folding arms, paper folding, computer simulations…)* • Exploring different types of angles and where they are used in the environment (*right angle, acute angle, obtuse angle, straight angle, reflex and a complete revolution)* • Measuring and drawing angles up to 360 degrees using a protractor	• Angles related to different contexts appropriately
4.6. SHAPES	**4.6.1 Plane Shapes**	4.6.1.1 Construct different shapes in the environment	• Exploring parallel and perpendicular lines • Drawing perpendicular and parallel lines using set squares • Investigating properties of polygons up to six sides (*trapezium, kite, rhombus, parallelogram, pentagon and hexagon*) • Drawing polygons using set square, protractor and compass • Drawing and making trapezium, kite, rhombus and parallelogram using appropriate tools • Drawing a circle using a pair of compass • Identifying the centre, diameter and radius of a circle.	• Different shapes constructed correctly

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
	4.6.2 Solid Shapes	**4.6.2.1** Create solid shapes	• Investigating properties of cuboids and cubes (*stating the number of vertices, edges and faces*) • Analysing shapes of cuboids and cubes by decomposing the solid shapes • Drawing nets of cuboids and cubes • Sketching/ drawing cuboids and cubes • Designing and making cubes and cuboids (*project work)*	• Solid shapes created correctly
4.7 MEASURES	4.7.1Time and Area	4.7.1.1. Apply the concept of measurement in different life in situations	• Determining duration of time elapsed between events (*subtraction and addition of time)* • Relating seconds, minutes, hours and day • Illustrating the concept of area by using nonstandard units such as squared grids, tiles • Describing standard units to measure area (mm^2, cm^2, m^2) • Deriving formulae for finding area of rectangle and square • Using the formulae for finding area of rectangle and square	• Concept of measurement applied appropriately
4.8 STATISTICS	4.8.1 Bar graphs and Line graphs	4.8.1.1 Present data in different forms	• Collecting and organizing data using the frequency table • Presenting data on bar graphs and line graphs • Interpreting data from bar graphs and line graphs • Use ICT tools to construct line and bar graphs	• Data presented in different forms correctly

GRADE 5

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
5.1. SETS	**5.1.1 Venn Diagrams**	5.1.1.1 Use set operations to present ideas in everyday life	• Illustrating the concept of the Universal set and its notation • Presenting two sets with some common members in a Venn diagram • Presenting two sets with no common members (*disjoint sets*) in a Venn diagram • Exploring and interpreting set notations and symbols from given data sets such as intersection and union sets of two given sets in a Venn diagram (*Including a case where one set is the subset of the other)*	• Set operations used to present ideas in different situations correctly
5.2. NUMBERS	**5.2.1. Roman Numerals**	5.2.1.1 Use the Roman numeration system to communicate ideas in life context	• Exploring Roman numerals • Converting numerals from Arabic to Roman numeration and vice versa • Ordering Roman numerals	• Roman numerals used to communicate in different situations appropriately
	5.2.2 Prime and Composite Numbers	5.2.2.1 Apply prime and composite numbers in everyday context	• Exploring prime and composite numbers • Identifying which numbers have just two and more factors • Illustrating the concept of prime numbers • Expressing a given number as a product of its prime factors • Illustrating the concept of composite numbers • Expressing composite numbers	• Prime and composite numbers applied in everyday context appropriately

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
5.3 FRACTIONS	**5.3.1 Common Fractions**	5.3.1.1 Apply fractions in everyday life	• Formulating equivalent fractions (by dividing or multiplying by the same number) • Adding and subtracting fractions with different denominators • Multiplying fractions by whole numbers • Multiplying whole numbers by fractions • Multiplying a fraction by another fraction • Ordering fractions	• Fractions applied in everyday life correctly
	5.3.2 Decimal Fractions	5.3.2.1 Utilize decimal fractions in everyday life	• Describing decimal numbers up to 3 • decimal places • Adding and subtracting decimal numbers up to 3 decimal places • Multiplying decimal numbers by decimal numbers (the product should not exceed 3 decimal places) • Dividing decimal numbers by decimal numbers (the dividend must be divisible by the divisor) • Ordering decimal fractions	• Decimal fractions utilised in everyday life correctly

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
5. 4 . COMBINED OPERATIONS	**5.4.1. Order of Operations**	**5.4.1.1** Apply combined operations in daily situations	• Illustrating commutative and associative laws of addition and multiplication • Illustrating distributive law of multiplication over addition and subtraction • Applying the commutative, associative and distributive laws • Exploring the order of carrying out operations • Carrying out combined operations	• Combined operations applied in daily situations correctly
5.5 ANGLES	**5.5.1. Related Angles**	**5.5.1.1** Apply angles in different life contexts	• Exploring the concept of complementary and supplementary angles (*including the use of ICT devices*) • Carrying out calculations involving complementary and supplementary angles.	• Angles applied in different contexts correctly
5.6 SHAPES	**5.6.1. Plane Shapes (Symmetry)**	5.6.1.1 Relate line of symmetry in life context	• Illustrating the concept of line symmetry through demonstration (*paper folding …*) • Completing shapes to make them symmetrical • Drawing lines of symmetry on plane shapes (*square, rectangle …*)	• Line of symmetry related in life contexts

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
	5.6.2 Solid Shapes	5.6.2.1 Create prisms in life context	• Investigating properties of a cylinder and a triangular prism • Identifying a cylinder and a triangular prism in the environment • Drawing of nets of cylinder and triangular prism • Sketching/drawing cylinder and triangular prism • Making cylinders and triangular prisms.	• Prisms in life context created accordingly
5.7. MEASURES	**5.7.1 Perimeter, Area and Volume**	5.7.1.1 Apply measurements in different life contexts	• Finding perimeter of triangle, parallelogram, trapezium, rhombus and composite shapes • Deriving formulae for area of triangle, parallelograms, trapezium and rhombus • Calculating areas of triangle, parallelogram, trapezium, rhombus and composite shapes • Illustrating the concept of volume using nonstandard units and water play • Describing and using standard units to measure volume (cm^3, m^3) • Deriving the formula for finding Volume • Calculating the volume of cubes and cuboids using formulae Exploring similarities and differences between volume and capacity.	• Measurements applied to different life situations appropriately

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
5.8 STATISTICS	**5.8.1 Stem- Leaf Plot and Pie Chart**	5.8.1.1 Present data in different forms	• Collecting and organizing data • Illustrating the concept of Stem-leaf plot and pie chart • Presenting data on Stem-leaf plot and pie chart (*including use of ICT*) • Interpreting data from Stem-leaf plot and pie chart	• Data presented in different forms correctly

GRADE 6

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
6.1 SETS	**6.1.1 Subsets**	6.1.1.1 Apply the concept of subsets in life context	• Identifying all the subsets of a set with 2or3 members (*justifying why an empty set is a subset of every set*) • Illustrating how the formula 2^n arises • Finding the number of subsets up to 3 members in a set • Finding the number of subsets using the formula 2^n (*n should not exceed 6)*	• Concepts of subsets applied in life contexts appropriately
6.2 INDEX NOTATION	**6.2.1 Indices**	6.2.1.1 Use index notation to solve life situations	• Illustrating the concept of index notation (*clearly show bases and powers*) • Rewriting numbers in index form to expanded notation and vice versa • Evaluating numbers in index notation (*bases and powers must be natural numbers)*	• Index notation used to solve life situations accordingly
	6.2.2 Numberand Sequence	6.2.2.1 Use squares and cubes to generate sequences	• Illustrating the concept of perfect squares • Finding squares of whole numbers • Illustrating the concept of cubic numbers • Finding cubes of whole numbers • Generating sequence in decreasing and increasing order	• Squares and cubes used to generate sequences correctly

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
6.3 FRACTIONS	**6.3.1 Common Fractions and Percentages**	6.3.1.1 Apply Fractions in different contexts	• Dividing fractions by whole numbers and vice versa • Dividing a fraction by another fraction • Carrying out calculations involving the four operations on fractions • Exploring the concept of percentages (*Relating* • *Percentages to hundredths…*) • Converting common fractions and decimal fractions to percentages and vice versa • Carrying out calculations involving percentages.	• Fractions applied in different contexts correctly
6.4 INTEGERS	**6.4.1 Operations on Integers**	6.4.1.1 Use integers in different contexts	• Exploring the concept of integers (use number line, ladder, computer simulations) • Comparing integers using greater than (>), less than (<) and equal to (=) • Ordering integers • Carrying out addition and subtraction of integers with and/or without using number lines • Multiplying and dividing integers	• Integers used in different contexts correctly

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
6.5 ESTIMATION AND APPROXIMATIONS	**6.5.1 Estimation and Approximation**	6.5.1.1 Apply estimation and approximation in daily life	• Estimating quantities in measurement (*distance, length …*) and compare with actual measurement • Rounding off numbers to the stated unit (*nearest ten, hundred, km, m, cm …*) • Rounding off decimals to the stated number of decimal places	• Estimation and Approximation applied appropriately
6.6 RATIO AND PROPORTION	**6.6.1 Ratio and Direct Proportion**	6.6.1.1. Use the concept of ratio and proportion in everyday situations	• Illustrating the meaning of ratio through the use of concrete and semi-concrete objects • Drawing diagrams to show some ratios that are equivalent • Expressing ratios to their lowest terms • Carrying out calculations involving ratio • Illustrating the concept of direct proportion in life situations • Carrying out calculations involving direct proportion • Establishing relationship between ratio and direct proportion • Applying unitary and proportional method in proportion situations (*exchange rates, measures …*) • Drawing graphs to illustrate quantities in direct proportion	• Concept of ratio and proportion used in everyday situations according

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
	6.6.2 Indirect proportion		• Exploring the concept of indirect proportion (Comparing direct proportion scenario with indirect proportion scenario) • Establishing relationship between ratio and indirect proportion. • Carrying out calculations involving indirect proportion • Drawing graphs to illustrate quantities in indirect proportion	
6.7 EQUATIONS AND INEQUATIONS	**6.7.1 Linear equations and inequations**	6.7.1.1 Apply linear equations and inequations in life situations	• Illustrating linear equations (*writing open sentences*) • Forming linear equations in one variable • Solving linear equations in one variable • Illustrating inequations in life contexts • Forming linear inequations in one variable • Calculating inequations in one variable	• Linear equations and inequations applied correctly

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
6.8 FINANCIAL ARITHMETIC	**6.8.1 Money**	6.8.1.1 Exhibit financial literacy in everyday life	• Interpreting the concept of discount, profit and loss giving real life situations such as buying and selling • Calculating discount, profit and loss • Calculating percentage discount, profit and loss • Interpreting the concept of simple interest • Calculating simple interest • Converting the foreign currencies to local and vice versa • Calculating the cost of goods priced in foreign currency	• Financial literacy shown in everyday life accordingly
6.9 MEASURES	**6.9.1 Length, Area and Speed**	6.9.1.1 Apply measurements in different life contexts	• Finding the total length of edges of cube and cuboid • Finding the total surface area of cubes and cuboids • Describing the meaning of speed • Calculating speed using distance and time • Calculating distance using speed and time • Calculating time using speed and distance	• Measurements applied in different life contexts

TOPIC	SUB TOPIC	SPECIFIC COMPETENCES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES	EXPECTED STANDARD
6.10 STATISTICS	**6.10.1 Measures of Central Tendency**	6.10.1.1 Analyse data	• Describing the measures of central tendency (*mean, mode, median)* • Calculating measures of central tendency (*mean, mode and median)*	• Data analysed correctly